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US equities rise on strong Dow, while tech stalls

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The Dow Jones surged **+1.08%** to `52,177.69`, pulling the broader market higher as the S&P 500 nudged **+0.33%** to `7,744.06`. The Nasdaq 100 slipped **-0.05%** to `29,935.60`, reflecting pressure on chip and AI-related names.

Yield compression continued with the 10-year Treasury at `5.09%` (-1.95%), while commodities fell; WTI crude dropped **-2.14%** to `95.87`. Defensive and cyclical ETFs posted mixed gains, led by financials (**+1.38%**) and consumer discretionary (**+1.71%**).

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,744.06	+0.33%	
Dow Jones	52,177.69	+1.08%	
Nasdaq 100	29,935.60	-0.05%	
Russell 2000	2,767.27	+1.38%	
VIX	16.46	-2.43%	
10Y Yield	5.09%	-1.95%	
WTI Crude	95.87	-2.14%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	PRICE	CHANGE
GS	891.28	+1.43%
MSFT	539.44	+1.08%
XLF	55.27	+1.38%
NVDA	217.23	-1.84%

Spotlight

Microsoft MSFT reported Q3 earnings, beating consensus on revenue (USD 62.1 bn vs. 61.4 bn) and delivering EPS of 2.48 versus 2.33. Cloud services grew 15% YoY, sustaining the bullish narrative for the sector.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	62.1 bn
EPS	2.48
Cloud growth	+15%
Guidance FY25 Rev.	+8%

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25%–5.50% (held steady)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.09% (down 1.95%)
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 03:30, Fed minutes 04:30
- Gold up +0.59% to 4,194.60; DXY down -0.07% to 101.93

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s manufacturing PMI posted 49.8, indicating near-stagnation.
- Eurozone inflation eases to 2.7% YoY, supporting ECB dovish stance.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30	`AAPL`	iPhone 17 demand, services margin
10:00	`NVDA`	AI GPU order backlog, guidance
10:30	`AMZN`	Advertising revenue, AWS growth
11:00	`TSLA`	Model Y production, margin trends

Stocks worth watching

- `META` – ad-tech rollout could lift revenue despite flat stock.
- `XLE` – energy ETF poised for rebound if oil stabilises.
- `JPM` – net interest income rising with yield curve flattening.
- `AVGO` – strong semiconductor back-end demand supports earnings.
- `XLB` – materials exposure to copper price recovery.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI or PCE above expectations.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East.
- Tech earnings miss, especially NVDA or AAPL.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Fed signals earlier rate cut.
- Strong cloud guidance from MSFT or AMZN.
- Oil prices settle below USD 90 per barrel.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets Summary

Bloomberg — S&P 500 Data

SEC — Microsoft Q3 2026 8-K

Federal Reserve — Minutes

EIA — Crude Oil Prices